IP FABRIC

CHROME EXTENSION

Installation & Configuration Guide

IP Fabric Global Search + LLM Interactive Session + Diff Dashboard — a single Manifest V3 Chrome extension that overlays embedded Global Search and an LLM Interactive Session onto the IP Fabric UI, plus a CVE Security Status Evaluate control and a Diff Dashboard on the IP Fabric header row. The LLM Interactive Session and CVE Security Status results link back into the IP Fabric UI, and the Diff Dashboard compares any Technology or Inventory table column between snapshots.

Audience IP Fabric administrators & users installing the extension **Version** 5.1.3

This guide covers installing the extension and configuring it for your IP Fabric deployment. Follow the first-time setup steps before using any feature — the extension ships with no keys, so it will not work until you supply your own.

First-time setup — you must do this before the extension works

No keys are bundled with this extension. The very first time you use it, you must open the Options page and paste in two keys of your own. Until you do, searches and the LLM session will not work.

1. Paste your IP Fabric Authorization Header key

You generate this key yourself inside your own IP Fabric VM instance:

- Log in to your IP Fabric web UI and go to Settings → Integration → API Tokens (older versions: Settings → API Tokens).
- Click Create Token, give it a description, and (at minimum) grant Read / Discovery permissions.
- Copy the generated token immediately — IP Fabric only shows it once and it cannot be displayed again after you close the dialog.
- In the extension's Options page, paste it into the Authorization header field as `Bearer YOUR_TOKEN` (keep the word Bearer followed by a space, then your token).

2. Paste your Anthropic Claude API key

This is only needed if you use the LLM features (the "LLM and MCP Server" search mode or the LLM Interactive Session) with the Anthropic Claude provider:

- Get a key from the Anthropic Console at console.anthropic.com (Settings → API Keys).
- In the extension's Options page, paste it into the Anthropic API key field (it looks like `sk-ant-api03-…`).

Where your keys are stored

Then click Save. Your keys are stored only in your own browser (`chrome.storage.sync`) — never in a file inside the extension, and never shared with anyone you give the extension to.

1 Install

1. Open chrome://extensions in Chrome (or any Chromium-based browser).
2. Enable Developer mode (top-right toggle).
3. Click Load unpacked and select the ipfabric-combined-extension folder.
4. Pin the extension to the toolbar.

After installing, reload any open demo2.eu.ipfabric.io tabs — the bar will appear at the top of each page.

Pointing at a different IP Fabric instance

Domain scoping is hardcoded in the manifest. To use a different deployment (e.g. your company's own IP Fabric URL), edit `manifest.json` and change every occurrence of `https://demo2.eu.ipfabric.io/*` to your URL, then reload the extension from chrome://extensions.

2 Configure

Right-click the toolbar icon → Options, or open chrome://extensions → the extension card → Extension options. Most users won't need to change anything — the default search mode (Cycle every table) uses your existing browser session and doesn't need any of the fields below.

The fields below are only used when Search mode is set to "LLM and MCP Server" (and by the LLM Interactive Session):

Field	Default
	Bearer … (IP Fabric MCP token)
	Anthropic Claude (or OpenAI / Azure / Groq / Ollama / LM Studio / LocalAI / vLLM / custom)
	`sk-ant-api03-…` (used when provider is Anthropic Claude)
	OpenAI-compatible endpoint, e.g. `http://localhost:1234/v1` (pre-filled per provider)
	e.g. `gpt-4o-mini`, `llama3.1` (blank = sensible default)
	optional; blank for local servers
	auto-detect, unused in LLM mode
	auto-detect, unused in LLM mode

When the provider is Anthropic Claude, only the Anthropic API key is needed; it's sent only to api.anthropic.com, and the IP Fabric MCP token is used by the extension's own MCP plumbing to authenticate to your IP Fabric MCP server.

OpenAI-compatible providers

When the provider is an OpenAI-compatible option, the Base URL / Model / API-key fields apply instead. Picking a provider pre-fills its base URL:

Provider	Base URL
	uses your resource-specific URL

On Save you'll be prompted to grant the extension permission to reach that host. Local servers don't need a key.

Verify your configuration

Click Test connection to verify the IP Fabric MCP credentials and see the list of available tools.

CVE Security Status

In addition to the two bar tools, the extension overlays a CVE Security Status label and an Evaluate button centered on the IP Fabric header row. Clicking Evaluate asks your configured LLM, working through the same agentic loop and IP Fabric MCP server the LLM features use, to enumerate the deployment's devices and OS versions and cross-reference them against published public CVE sources (NVD, CISA KEV, and vendor advisories), including configuration-specific CVEs that are reported in a dedicated Configuration Specific section of the output. It therefore needs the same LLM provider settings and IP Fabric MCP credentials configured above — there is nothing extra to set up. Its findings, like the LLM Interactive Session's results, are rendered with clickable links back into the IP Fabric UI (see “Clickable IP Fabric UI links” below). The results render below the bar in the same format as the Global Search and LLM Interactive Session results, opening below the CVE Security Status control so they never cover its label or buttons, and the control carries the same results-toggle and gear (Options) buttons — to the right of Evaluate — so you can re-show the persisted results after clicking back on the page, exactly like the other two tools.

Showing or hiding the control

The CVE Security Status control can be shown or hidden independently in Options → Display → Show CVE Security Status, with the same show / hide behavior as the Global Search and LLM

Interactive Session overlays. The small "IP Fabric Toolbar" restore group (with its Show options button) only appears when all three overlays are hidden; while any one of them — including CVE Security Status — is shown, that feature's own gear is reachable and the restore group stays hidden.

Clickable IP Fabric UI links

In the LLM Interactive Session and CVE Security Status results — both on screen and in the exported HTML reports — each item is rendered as a clickable link into the IP Fabric web UI: a device opens the device inventory filtered to that host, a site opens the site overview filtered to that site, a snapshot opens its snapshot-management page, and each CVE finding opens the device(s) it affects. (Global Search already produced its own deep links and is unchanged.)

There is nothing to configure

The links are built from the IP Fabric instance the extension is already running on and are pinned to the snapshot the results were computed from, which the extension reads from the host page. No extra keys, permissions, endpoints or settings are required beyond the ones described above — the feature is on by default whenever the LLM Interactive Session or CVE Security Status produces results.

What the links need to work

- An IP Fabric login. The links open the IP Fabric UI, so you must be logged in to the instance in that browser — exactly as with the Global Search deep links. This applies to links opened from a saved HTML report too.
- Read access to the target page. A link lands on a normal IP Fabric table, so your IP Fabric user needs permission to view it.

Links are only generated where the target can be resolved with confidence from data the MCP tools actually returned. An item the extension cannot map to a specific IP Fabric page is rendered as plain text rather than as a link that would land on an empty or unrelated view, so no result is ever given a fabricated link.

Diff Dashboard

The extension also overlays a Diff Dashboard button on the IP Fabric header row. It opens a panel that compares any Technology or Inventory table column between the current snapshot and another snapshot you choose, showing exactly what was added, removed, or changed. The Diff Dashboard uses your existing IP Fabric login session, so — like Global Search's Cycle every table mode — it needs no API keys or tokens to work.

Showing or hiding the Diff Dashboard

The Diff Dashboard can be shown or hidden independently in Options → Display → Show Diff Dashboard, with the same show / hide behavior as the Global Search, LLM Interactive Session, and CVE Security Status overlays. When it is shown, its button sits on the IP Fabric header row and automatically positions itself to avoid the Global Search bar and the CVE Security Status control; when it is hidden, the button and its panel are removed entirely.

Diff Dashboard settings

Two Diff-specific settings live in Options → Diff Dashboard. Ignore volatile fields (age, uptime) — recommended on — makes a next-hop (or other nested value) count as changed only when the real data changes, not when a timer such as age advances. Reset Diff Dashboard position & size returns the panel to its default docked position if you have dragged or resized it.

Choosing how rows are matched

The Diff Dashboard pairs rows between the two snapshots using a match key — the columns shown under Rows matched on — and then watches the field you picked in Column to compare for changes on those paired rows. The match key decides which row is which across snapshots; the compare column decides what counts as a change. The compare column is always excluded from the key automatically, so that a change to it reads as Changed rather than as one row being removed and a different one added.

The key is derived automatically for each table and is a sensible default, but you can click Edit match key in the panel to add or remove columns. Add columns when the default is too coarse and several real entries collapse into one row — for example, matching the MPLS Forwarding table on its label columns gives a true per-entry comparison. Remove a column when it changes between snapshots and makes an unchanged object look removed-then-added. Reset to auto restores the default; the full behaviour is covered in the User Guide.